

American Modernism

Retrospectively called American Modernism, art produced in the United States during the fast-paced period between c.1910 and 1950 involved numerous ideas, experiments and explorations. Early artists under this umbrella term, such as Edwin Dickinson (1891–1978), Arthur Dove (1880–1946) and Georgia O’Keeffe (1887–1986), used nature as a starting point.

In 1913, the Armory Show in New York City was the first large display of modern art in America. With some 1,300 works of art by over 300 avant-garde European and American artists, it was ridiculed by press and public, but inspired many artists, who began exploring different techniques and modes of expression. Various groups formed and movements developed, including the Ashcan School; the Stieglitz circle led by photographer Alfred Stieglitz (1864–1946); and The Eight, a group of influential painters. Artists explored topics such as the landscape, poverty and social injustice. Despite initial resistance by the public, the new art movements soon established a unique American identity.



O'Keeffe, *Red Poppy, No. VI*, 1928